

THE WOMAN IN THE NEW AGE

Greetings, my very beloved, dearest friends. Blessings for every one of you here. I have promised to give a lecture tonight about the woman in the new age. I will do so with joy and great pleasure. I shall speak of the evolution of consciousness as it relates to the woman and to the man-woman relationship. One cannot discuss this topic without seeing the evolving relationship between the sexes.

As the planet is maturing, so are men and women. What does this aspect of maturity really mean? Where have woman and man come from in the evolutionary movement, and where are they going? What is the ultimate realization of womanhood -- and of manhood? Woman is coming into her own in this phase of history; she is coming out of her confinement.

At the dawn of mankind, mankind was in a very primitive state of development. Distrust was rampant. Distrust in everything and anything other than the self. Distrust of the phenomena of nature, of animals, of the weather, of the gods, of fate, of other tribes -- anything that was different, strange, foreign, or that seemed that way. Therefore, of course, distrust of the opposite sex was also very strong. Man innately distrusted woman, and woman man. Each seemed justified in his or her distrust by dint of the other's distrustful attitude. Since man was physically the stronger and since physicality was the sole expression of mankind at its dawn, he also assumed a general aura of superiority over all who were weaker.

The mutual distrust and man's physical domination were very overtly acted out in these early periods of humanity. Since then, to a lesser degree, the same traits and attitudes remained imbedded in the consciousness of woman and man. They may be overshadowed by more realistic and mature awareness. They may not be acted out in the same way, but there remains a hidden corner in the psychic substance that needs to be brought out and changed in the course of the total development of all human beings. When you look back in history, you can see that the planet did what so many individuals do -- retaining an attitude long after it is meaningful, or purposeful, or adequate to the general development of the entity. So man retained a position of superiority long after physical prowess ceased to be considered the prime value. Other values had come into existence as development progressed, values that certainly apply equally to both sexes. Yet, man (and often women as well) persisted in considering man the superior and woman the inferior. To justify this assumption and make it a "fact," woman was supposed to be intellectually and morally weaker. But you all know this.

To the degree man did not meet and deal with his own feelings of inferiority and weakness, to the degree he wished to pretend that he did not have those feelings, he assumed a position of arrogance and superiority over those who were weaker in physical strength. He needed slaves in

order to convince himself of his own value. This applied to animals, to peoples whom he conquered and subjugated through warfare, and also to women. Woman chose later to assume a mental and emotional position of dependency and thus actively chose enslavement no matter how much she tried to put the blame exclusively on man.

By the same token, man expressed and evinced fear toward those who were physically stronger than he. And the more the fear existed toward those who were stronger, the greater the urge became to subjugate weaker people. This is a human trait in the unenlightened person that you well know from your own inner processes. It is a compensatory phenomenon. This attitude still exists in the consciousness of mankind even today. It is not something that woman is free of, for when you look very deeply into your own consciousness, you will find similar attitudes embedded in yourself. There is also a part in woman that contributed to the situation in the age that has just passed. Why has woman been subjugated and denied her birthright of self-expression, of mental, emotional, and spiritual equality with the man so long after physical prowess had ceased to be an individual's main value? Woman could not simply be a victim to man's egotistical desires to feel superior and stronger, to possess the woman as an object. The woman also plays a role here.

You, my friends, who are on this path, no longer find it extremely difficult to ascertain attitudes in you where you do not want to assume self-responsibility, where you want to be taken care of by a stronger authority figure. Again, similar attitudes exist in man. However, in the old interrelationship between man and woman, the woman victimized herself by acting out on the level of outer behavior a denial of self-responsibility. She acted out giving in to the line of least resistance so as to be taken care of. She wanted an authority figure to make decisions for her, to take the consequences of her mistakes, to take the blame, to take the responsibility, and to battle with the hardships of life. She wanted to indulge in the pseudo-comfort of a subjugated state.

It has turned out to be a disappointing, unfulfilling way of life, as all misconceptions sooner or later must lead to that. But woman has again abstained from taking her share of the responsibility for this state of affairs. Now she puts all the blame on the man.

The new woman's movement contains a great deal of truth, but it is, as in all dualistic approaches, but a half-truth. The truth is that woman indeed possesses the same faculties of intelligence, of resourcefulness, of creativity, of psychic strength, of productive self-expression in life as the man. To claim that she does not makes no sense at all and has become a game on the part of man who does not want to face his own feelings of weakness and inferiority and who therefore needs to feel superior to woman.

By the same token, woman, in order to make the new women's movement truly meaningful, must ascertain within herself the part that has invited her enslavement. I would venture to say, the stronger the outer rebellion and the blaming of the opposite sex, the stronger must also be within the soul of that individual woman the desire not to govern her own life, not to be responsible and take the consequences of her actions and decisions and lean on someone else. To the degree that she makes unfair and unrealizable demands, she must resent and blame male authority and play a game of victimization.

On the other hand, to the degree the man does not face his fears, his guilts and weaknesses, he will play a power game in one form or another and then resent the woman for exploiting him and

putting too much of a burden on him. In the immature soul, both want the advantage without paying the price: the man wants the superior position but resents the price of taking care of a parasite. The woman wants the advantage of being taken care of, of not standing on her own two feet, but resents the price of losing her autonomy. Both play the same game but hesitate to see their mutual creation in this distortion.

On a still deeper level of the consciousness of man and woman, the opposite of the manifest behavior also exists. The man also carries an aspect where he shrinks away from the responsibility of adulthood and envies the woman her position that was socially sanctioned for her for so long. He overcompensates for this by too much emphasis on the power game. The woman hides a part in her where she, too, wants aggression, power, strength -- not only in the real sense but also in the distorted sense. She envies man for it. In former times, this side of her had to be totally submerged. It was not sanctioned socially, just as the man's counterpart was rejected. Only recently has this part emerged, but it is often still confused with genuine selfhood. Both men and women must find their way out of the confusion: how can man be an equal to the woman without being weak? How can woman have her emotional fulfillment and still be an autonomous adult? These are not real opposites, but results of the dualistic confusion.

When movements, orientations, and philosophies do not deal with the whole picture, but with only half of the picture, it is impossible to set the balance right. It will merely become the opposite imbalance from the one that existed previously. Although in the course of evolution the pendulum must swing to some degree from one extreme and exaggeration into its exact opposite, deeper and wiser insight into the unitive truth can help to avoid excess in this respect.

You know these principles that I have discussed again and again on this path. One is the principle of dualism versus the principle of unitive consciousness. In duality, the man will feel superior and believe woman to be inferior. He will consequently exploit her but will also feel exploited by her. In such a relationship, fulfillment is impossible. And the woman will feel that she is being unfairly put upon and exploited by the physically stronger man and will blame him for being victimized. Both will fail to see the other side where they are indeed very similar and where they complement one another in a distorted way.

I have spoken before about some of the points I have to mention in this lecture. So once again I will have to repeat myself. I have mentioned a long time ago that both the feminine and the masculine principles must be represented in the healthy individual. They may not be expressed in exactly the same way in man and in woman, for the differences make up the whole. But the differences are not of a qualitative kind. They must never lead to a comparative value judgment that one is better or more developed than the other.

Let us have a glimpse of the woman in the new age. Let me paint a picture, and then let us see how this applies to the relationship between the sexes. The new woman is completely self-responsible and therefore free. She stands on her own two feet, not only materially but also intellectually, mentally, and emotionally. By that, I mean specifically that she knows that no man can give her happiness and the pleasure of the flowing feelings unless she herself produces them through loving and through integrity, through opening her heart to loving and opening her mind to her own inner truth. The new woman knows that loving a man and surrendering to her feelings for the man enhances her strength as an individual. It does not diminish her strength. There is no conflict for

the woman in the new age between being a productive, creative, contributing member of society, and a loving mate. There is not only no conflict whatsoever, but, in fact, real love is not possible toward someone to whom one plays a slave in order to abdicate one's self-responsibility. The old fairy tale that a woman's career will make her less of a woman, less feeling, less loving, less equipped to be a giving mate has never had any substance in reality.

This new state requires a strength and autonomy that needs to be earned. It needs to be earned by standing in life, standing in reality, and shouldering reality with all that this means. But you have to do so not in a spirit of hate, rebellion, competition, defiance, not by imitating the worst excesses and distortions of manhood, the negative aggression, and the power games. It has to be done through the power of truth and love, from the higher self. Whenever something real is denied due to misconceptions, due to the false ideas that it is too difficult, those difficulties must first be accepted before they prove themselves not so difficult at all. Self-responsibility seems too difficult, but really it is not, once the apparent hardships are accepted because doing so really amounts to honesty in the approach to life.

Where distortion still exists, woman still wants from the man what she refuses to do for herself. In the new age woman, this will not be the case. This does not mean that two people sharing their life together do not also share, naturally, their difficulties. But this is not what I am talking about here. You know from your path perfectly well that what you secretly wanted from a superior father authority, you shifted onto a mate. You also know how such an implicit desire is bound to destroy any relationship. It is bound to make you resent and fear the very authority you wish to exploit in this way. Love can only flower in a climate of true equality, where no fear exists and therefore no defenses, no blame. Contrary to the fairy tale that femininity blossoms when the woman is just a servant to the man, feelings can actually only blossom when the woman is free, autonomous, independent in the best sense of the word. So fulfillment is completely dependent on a true state of equality. The moment one feels superior to the other, one's respect is lowered, and thus the feelings close. The moment one feels inferior to the other, resentment, fear, envy become inescapable, and that too closes the heart.

The new woman is neither a slave to the man, nor is she in competition with him. Therefore she can love, and her love will never lessen her creative self-expression, but only enhance it just as her creative contribution to life can only enhance her love capacity. That is the new woman.

The man in the new age will no longer need a weaker mate in order not to feel his own weakness. The man in the new age meets his own weakness, faces it, and thereby gains his real strength. He realizes that his weakness is always guilt, and his self-rejection is always a denial of the integrity of his higher self in one form or another. Therefore the need for a slave no longer exists. The man is then not threatened by an equal. He does not require an inferior mate in order to convince himself of his acceptability. This is of course always an illusory acceptability. Since he faces his weakness, he must gain his strength. Therefore his relating to the woman is truly one of equality where he is not threatened by someone who is as creative, as adequate, as morally strong, as intelligent as himself. He will not need to play the master. Again, this enables man to open his heart and to experience a fulfillment that was previously quite impossible. Thus, whatever vicious circles existed will now turn into benign circles. Instead of the inferiority feelings closing the heart, creating resentment and hate and therefore creating frustration and therefore creating blame toward the other sex, the benign circle will open the heart. The fully autonomous, self-reliant, self-responsible,

self-actualizing man and woman have nothing to fear, to envy, to resent in the other sex. Therefore they can open all the channels of feelings, and therefore they can experience fulfillment and also a sense of gratitude toward the mate. Two equals help each other in their growth as individuals, as man and woman. This is the new age man, the new age woman, and the new age relationship.

And where this does not yet exist, the mere fact that you can point out the fallacies within you -- the distorted expectations; the illusory aims; the negative feelings that are a result of false ideas, of misconceptions -- and that you are also aware of your stake, your negative intentionality to maintain an inner warfare, that in itself will give you an entirely different stand toward yourself and toward the other. So the new age man and the new age woman are not necessarily perfect and totally developed individuals. However, they are individuals who look for the pitfalls, for the reason for their lack of fulfillment just as much in themselves as in the other and thus can recognize a negative mutuality and interaction that can be worked out together. They do not assume the stance of self-righteous blame to widen the gap between the self and other, between the self and truth. Autonomy is an ever growing process which makes distrust disappear. The distrust that still exists between the sexes is a residue of the ancient times when anything that was foreign and different was feared, rejected, and an attempt was made to subdue it. In the new age, differences will no longer induce fear. When the universe is trusted, difference always possesses a special attraction. When you do not fear difference but are attracted by it, you are fully actualizing yourself and dissolving blocks of untruth; you realize your highest potentials. But when that is not the case and you fear and distrust the difference and deny that which is different, then you can use this as a gauge of how you wish to remain in untruth and suffering.

In the present state of humanity's consciousness, you find on many levels all these different stages of development. The highest form may already exist in your consciousness to some degree. You may in your conscious thinking truly embrace some of these ideas I have expressed here. But then there are also deeper levels where your emotional reactions do not at all agree with the ideas you consciously embrace. It does no good to postulate the conscious ideals of these ideas without also seeing where you yourself deviate from them and how you deviate from them. For that is the only way to safeguard against imbalance and disharmony within and therefore also against creating it outside. The next lecture will deal with the topic of balance and harmony, generally speaking.

There is of course one key to everything that exists, and that key is love. Without that key, nothing could be mended, nothing could unify, no truth could ever be gained. And yet it is equally true to say that love cannot be gained without truth. In a deep corner in the heart of man and woman, hate and fear still prevail; resentments and distrust still prevail. But even more importantly, the will to maintain this state, the intentionality to perpetuate and hide this fact prevents the flowering of the heart and the mind of man and woman. To the degree that this is so, you have not gained yourself and you are not able to relate to the other and fulfill yourself. To attempt such relating and fulfillment while this attitude is unchanged is sheer waste, is utterly futile.

So, I say to you, my dearest friends, find that corner in your heart, that small hidden crevice where you hate the other sex. And where you also defend yourself against recognizing this by blaming, accusing, resenting, and closing your heart and your feelings with apparent justification. The woman will use the game of victimization, the man will use the game of blame and superiority. He will blame her for exploiting and using him and feel superior to that part in the woman that makes her weak.

Temporarily the pendulum has swung into the opposite extreme. The woman has become militant, thereby often forgetting her heart and her love for the man and rejecting the attitude of loving. In the countermovement of the pendulum, man has left his positive aggression behind and has expressed in this evolutionary movement a weakness he would never have let himself expose in previous eras.

All these contrary deviations have a purpose. It is to find the true centered state. As I said before, man will now find his real strength. He had to leave the false strength, the false superiority behind. He had to go temporarily into overt weakness, and he is now coming into a new strength, a strength that is able to face the weakness. Thereby he expands the real values and the real force in him. Therefore he does not need to be the superior member of the team. He can afford to let his heart speak and relate from the heart on the feeling level to his partner. He can likewise relate on a level of equality with his mind to the mind of his woman. That is the man of the new age.

For this to happen, my dearest friends, you need to go into this deeper part of you where you do not want to forgive, where you do not want to understand the truth and where you want to preserve your case and go on hating. You need to release the hatred toward the other sex. You have to pray for this ability to love, to forgive, to understand, and to see that what you hate and fear and distrust exists in you in exactly the same way -- though perhaps manifesting in a different way.

The woman is as much a representation of the active principle as the man. And the man is as much a representation of the receptive principle as the woman. In their coming together in sexual union, this may not always express outwardly in the same way, but the inner forces must combine both the active and receptive principles. Otherwise imbalance exists. No true man can be a man unless he incorporates the receptive or, as it is called, the feminine principle. If he only expresses the masculine principle, he becomes a caricature of a man. He is then a bully, a tyrant, an exaggeration, a falsehood. By the same token, a woman who only expresses the receptive principle is a caricature of a woman and is truly an infant who leans on others, who negates her autonomy. So, in order to be fully receptive on the feeling level, she has to express the active principle every bit as much as the man.

The two principles must be represented in both and must complement one another while they are at times also parallel. This perfect balance cannot be thought out through the mind or through an intellectual decision. It can only be found organically through the inner act of love, the inner act of releasing the other sex from the bondage of hate, distrust, and blame. When this release is pronounced in daily meditation, when God's grace can go to work within the consciousness of the woman as well as of the man, then love will lead to truth just as much as truth will lead to love. And the two sexes will function as equally productive human beings in the new universe, complementing and aiding one another, loving one another, respecting one another, and creating a new world, side by side creating bliss for each other. This is the way.

And now, my dear ones, I'm ready for your questions.

QUESTION: (inaudible)

ANSWER: You may have noticed a pattern on this path, my friends, in which it invariably happens that an individual must first resolve his career problems before partnership problems can truly be resolved. In the context of this lecture, this will become very clear. When relationships are formed to act out dependency, parasitism, exploitation of the other, and/or the need to dominate and enslave; then, for a while, these individuals have to fend for themselves until a certain minimal autonomy and independence is established. Once this creative channel is established, a new freedom can release previously trapped energies, and people can begin to relate to the other sex in an entirely new way.

I was very happy to give you this lecture, for everything that leads toward the further unfoldment of the whole person -- man and woman -- is a joyful experience for us in our world. See the beauty of the Christ that goes through all of you. Be in peace, be your God.

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